

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'That Which Thoroughly Pacifies Epidemic Illness'

Ārya-jvara-praśamanī nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 625 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྣམས་ནད་རབ་ཏུ་ཞི་བར་བརྟེན་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཟུངས།

Toh 625 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-jvara-praśamanī nāma dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakpa Rimné Rabtu Zhiwar Jepai Zhejawai Gzungs, rendered in English as "The Noble Dhāraṇī Called That Which Thoroughly Pacifies Epidemic Illness." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and is a relatively brief scriptural work in which the Buddha, dwelling at the charnel ground known as the Cool Grove near Rājagṛha, responds to a monk's concern about sentient beings afflicted by illness by imparting a sacred dhāraṇī for the pacification of epidemic disease. The text combines a short narrative frame with a protective formula and instructions for its ritual application, including the prescription that the written dhāraṇī, when worn around the neck, will ward off epidemic illness.

nityajvaraṃ svāhā. This ritual, when written and hung around the neck, eliminates epidemic illness. The dhāraṇī for pacifying epidemic illness is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya-jvara-praśamanī nāma dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "That Which Thoroughly Pacifies Epidemic Illness."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling in the great charnel ground called the Cool Grove, near Rājagṛha. Then a certain monk approached the Blessed One, and having come before him, prostrated with his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, that monk addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Venerable Blessed One, there are sentient beings here who are afflicted and tormented by epidemic illness. I entreat the Blessed One to protect them."

Then the Blessed One looked to one side and spoke to the venerable Ānanda:

"Ānanda, in this region there dwells an epidemic illness called Flame-Garland. It afflicts sentient beings in the manner of a one-day, two-day, three-day, and four-day fever. The foundation of the secret mantra for warding it off is as

follows:

tadyathā — jvalani jvalani prajvalani pratipani praśamani — may my epidemic illness depart, may it not remain — svāhā.

By the truth, and by the words of truth by which in this world the buddhas are supreme, and by which in this world the Dharma and the Saṅgha are supreme — by that truth and those words of truth, may my epidemic illness depart, may it not remain — svāhā.

siddhyantu mantrapadai — taratu — vidyātaṃ brahma anumate svāhā.

Recite this twenty-one times over a black thread and tie twenty-one knots."

Having thus spoken, those monks rejoiced and were delighted at what the Blessed One had declared, and they wholeheartedly...

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end with "□□□□□□□□," indicating this passage is incomplete as given. The final phrase likely completed a standard sūtra closing formula such as "they wholeheartedly approved" or "they rejoiced and approved."

The mantra syllables are transliterated from Sanskrit and left in their phonetic form as is conventional for dhāraṇī texts. The phrase "siddhyantu mantrapadai taratu vidyātaṃ brahma anumate svāhā" is a formulaic ratification phrase common to dhāraṇī texts, meaning roughly "may the mantra-words be accomplished; may the vidyā, approved by Brahma, carry one across — svāhā."

The term "Flame-Garland" renders the Tibetan རྒྱལ་མཚན་ལྷ་མོ་, a name for a specific fever-spirit or epidemic deity; the one-day through four-day fever classification reflects classical Āyurvedic and Buddhist medical categories of intermittent fevers.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.